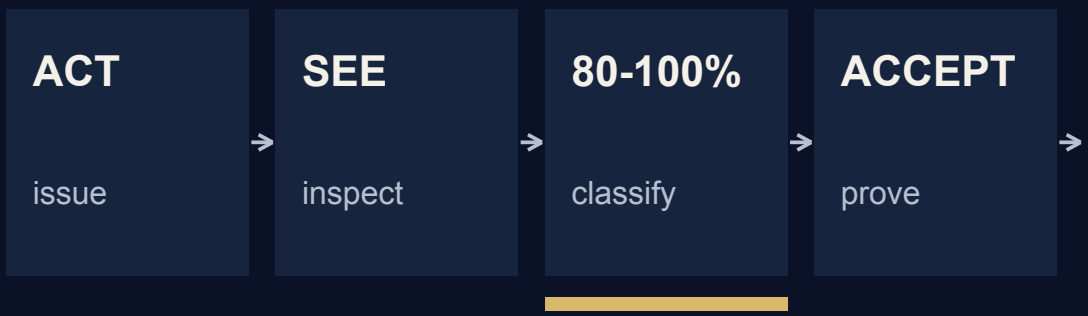
The finish line is twenty points wide.

Google's highest robot-progress band spans 80% through 100%. Almost finished and finished can share one label.

FROM ACTION TO AN ACCEPTED OUTCOME



The top band still contains unfinished work.

Google-reported model benchmark. The proposed tabletop comparison was not run.

> **Progress is useful evidence. It is not the acceptance receipt.**

Five bands compress a continuous job.

Progress classification turns a changing physical state into one of five broad labels.

BAND	POSSIBLE STATE	ACCEPTED?
0-20%	Started	No
20-40%	In progress	No
40-60%	In progress	No
60-80%	Nearer the end	No
80-100%	Almost done or done	UNKNOWN

The final state must be defined outside the progress band. UNKNOWN is not a failure; it means the class alone cannot decide.

> **The label reduces ambiguity. It does not remove the boundary problem.**

S1 · S4 · S6 | Google ER 2 documented progress bands

Two strong numbers. Two different questions.

Google reports one benchmark for broad progress and another for locating an event in video.

PROGRESS CLASSIFICATION

57.4%

Which broad band?

Five possible labels

Accepted output: not measured

MOMENT FINDING

91.3%

When did an event appear?

0.96s mean absolute distance

Accepted output: not measured

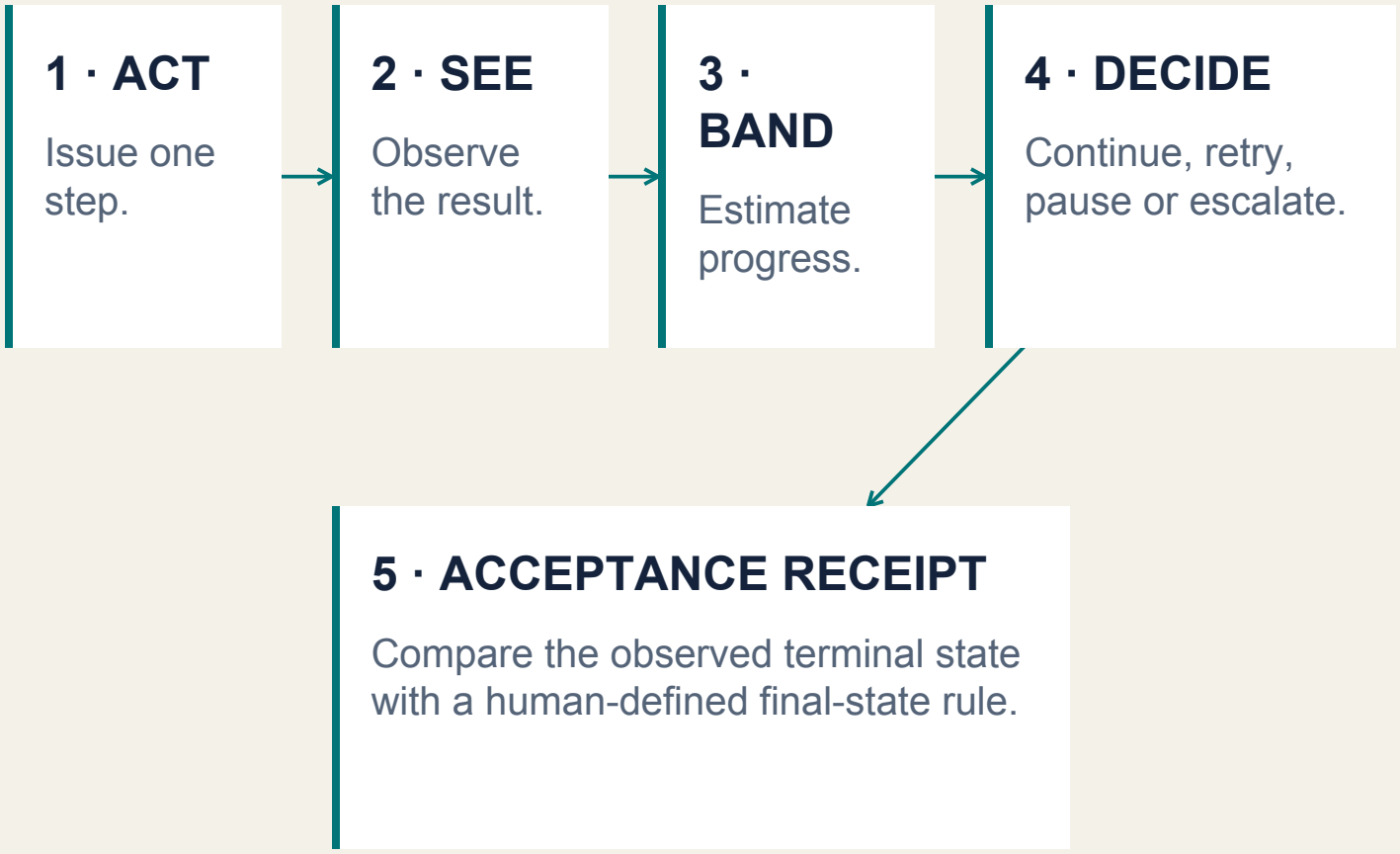
The reviewed public material does not provide the case-level evidence needed to map either benchmark to a workplace false-completion rate.

> **Neither number is a customer-job completion rate.**

S1 · S4 · S6 | Vendor-reported model benchmarks

Acceptance needs its own gate.

The model can add a check between act and continue. A system still needs an external terminal-state rule.



Certified hardware, redundancy and real-time guarantees remain separate deployment layers. Safety-critical use is excluded by the model card.

> **Put the acceptance receipt after the model judgment, not inside it.**

S1 · S2 · S4 · S5 · S6 | System design inference from documented interfaces

Selective retry may save work. It may also add attempts.

The mechanism changes where recovery begins. Its value depends on the accepted outcome after time and attention are counted.

FULL RESTART

Begin again

Discards prior completed steps

Simple recovery boundary

Accepted outcome: UNKNOWN

STEP-LOCAL RETRY

Return to one step

May preserve useful work

Depends on correct diagnosis and replan

Accepted outcome: UNKNOWN

Google's safety report distinguishes requesting confidence from reliably generating every revised substep needed to finish.

> **A smarter retry policy is a hypothesis until matched trials finish.**

S1 · S2 · S4 · S5 · S6 | Proposed comparison · not executed

Test the policy against a real finish line.

Use the same harmless tabletop tasks, the same terminal-state rules and repeated matched trials.

01

1 · Freeze

Three harmless tasks with visible terminal states and no people in the robot workspace.

02

2 · Match

Compare full restart and step-local retry on the same task instances.

03

3 · Accept

Apply one human-defined final-state check to both policies.

04

4 · Count

Accepted completion, false success, failed retries and human takeover.

05

5 · Cost

Elapsed time, model usage and operator time per accepted completion.

No tabletop or customer-site trial was run. Production performance is UNKNOWN.

Count accepted output, false success and the full recovery cost.

The check is new.
The finish line is still ours.

ER 2 can make progress observable and retry selective. The external acceptance gate decides whether the work counts.

MODEL STATUS

Which progress band
did the system see?

Did the final state pass the external acceptance rule?

Build the acceptance receipt before scaling the retry loop.

Google-reported benchmarks · No robot trial · No safety-critical use

> **Measure what finished—not only what moved forward.**